

August

12

1883

Lost species

The last living quagga, a type of South African zebra hunted to extinction in the wild, died at the Natura Artis Magistra zoo in Amsterdam, Netherlands.



Also on this day

1990 One of the largest-ever *Tyrannosaurus rex* fossils, nicknamed “Sue”, was discovered in South Dakota, USA.

2016 Scientists declared they had found the longest-living vertebrate animal – a nearly 400-year-old Greenland shark.

2018 NASA’s *Parker Solar Probe* was launched to study the Sun. Travelling to the Sun at a speed of 690,000 kph (428,746 mph), it became the fastest human-made object in history.



1851

Smart sewing

US inventor Isaac

Merritt Singer received a patent for his sewing machine, which improved upon existing designs. It held the fabric in place and had a needle that moved up and down very quickly.

Born this day

1911 Mario Moreno, Mexican actor. Better known by his stage name Cantinflas, he was one of Latin America’s most popular comedians.

1865

Antiseptic revolution

British surgeon Joseph Lister sprayed a chemical called carbolic acid on his patient’s wounds during surgery, preventing infection by harmful airborne microorganisms. Lister’s first antiseptic was soon widely used, and death rates dropped dramatically.

